# What to do if a Person is Symptomatic

tree 1

**These recommendations are for the general public, not including health care settings or schools. For K-12 schools information, see the Symptom Decision Tree and Contact Tracing Checklist for K-12 Schools.**

**Isolate at home while confirming diagnosis if a person has one or more of these new, changed, or worsening symptoms:**

- ❑ Fever (≥100.4°F) or chills
- ❑ Shortness of breath or difficulty breathing
- ❑ Muscle or body aches
- ❑ New loss of taste or smell
- ❑ Congestion or runny nose
- ❑ Nausea, vomiting, or diarrhea
- ❑ Headache
- ❑ Fatigue
- ❑ Sore throat
- ❑ Cough

Are symptoms consistent with a diagnosed chronic illness?

NO

YES

**Complete home testing, a community-based test, or see a provider.**

If they do not receive an alternative named diagnosis from a health care provider **OR** do not get tested

They test **POSITIVE** for COVID-19

They test **NEGATIVE** for COVID-19 **OR** receive an alternative named diagnosis from a health care provider

Are they a known **close contact**[1]**?**

NO

YES

AND

## Isolate at home

They can return to community and most workplaces after **5 days** have passed since symptoms first appeared if:

1. No fever within the past 24 hours (without medication)

**AND**

2. Symptoms have improved
3. They continue to wear a mask around others for an additional 5 days[2]
4. Check your company's protocol before returning to work
5. Avoid people who are immunocompromised and health care facilities and other high-risk settings, for at least 10 days
6. Refer to What to do if you test positive for COVID-19 for more information, including what to do if you cannot wear a mask and what to do in congregate settings

## Identify close contacts

See **Tree 2** for what close contacts should do

see tree 2

## Stay home

They can return to community and most workplaces if:

1. No fever within the past 24 hours (without medication)

**AND**

2. Symptoms have improved

[1] **Close contact:** Someone who was within 6 feet of a COVID-19 case(s) for a total of 15 minutes or more within 24 hours during the case's contagious period. The definition of a close contact may vary in some situations. The local health department makes the ultimate determination of a close contact during its investigation, but may delegate this decision if appropriate.

[2] If you cannot wear a well-fitting mask: You should complete the full 10-day isolation or quarantine at home. Follow the guidance in this document only if you can wear a well-fitting mask. See the What to do if you test positive for COVID-19 and What to do if you were potentially exposed to someone with COVID-19 documents for additional information.

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# Identify and Care for Close Contacts

**These recommendations are for the general public, not including health care settings or schools. For K-12 schools information, see the Symptom Decision Tree and Contact Tracing Checklist for K-12 Schools.**

If someone is identified as a close contact of a person with COVID-19, is the exposed person (close contact[1]) **up-to-date on COVID-19 vaccinations**[3] **OR** have they **tested positive in the past 90 days and recovered?** (For persons who have tested positive in the past 90 days and recovered, use antigen tests in steps below.)

## YES

Do they have symptoms?

### NO

**Quarantine not needed**

Person should:

1. **Get tested at least five days** after known exposure
2. Continue **wearing a mask** around others for 10 days after known exposure
3. **Watch for symptoms** for 10 days after close contact

### YES

**Isolate and Test for COVID-19**



They test **NEGATIVE** for COVID-19

**Stay home**

They can return to community and most workplaces if:

1. No fever within the past 24 hours (without medication)

**AND**

2. Symptoms have improved

**AND**

3. Continue wearing a mask around others for 10 days after close contact



They test **POSITIVE** for COVID-19 **OR** do not get tested

**Isolate at home**

They can return to community and most workplaces after **5 days** have passed since symptoms first appeared if:

1. No fever within the past 24 hours (without medication)

**AND**

2. Symptoms have improved
3. They continue to wear a mask around others for an additional 5 days[2]
4. Check your company's protocol before returning to work
5. Avoid people who are immunocompromised and health care facilities and other high-risk settings, for at least 10 days.
6. Refer to What to do if you test positive for COVID-19 for more information, including what to do if you cannot wear a mask and what to do in congregate settings

## NO

Do they have symptoms?

### YES

**Isolate and Test for COVID-19**



They test **NEGATIVE** for COVID-19

A confirmatory viral test[4] may be needed. They should check with their health care provider.

### NO

**Quarantine at home**

They can return to community and most workplaces after **5 days** have passed since last close contact if:

1. If they can test, they test negative on or after day five since last close contact
2. Continue wearing a mask around others for an additional 5 days[2]
3. They remain without symptoms and watch for symptoms for 10 days after close contact
4. Refer to What to do if you were potentially exposed to someone with COVID-19 for information, including what to do if you cannot wear a mask, testing and quarantine details, and what to do in congregate settings

[3] A person is up-to-date on COVID-19 vaccinations when they have received their primary series AND additional doses or booster doses when eligible based on health status and age.

[4] Confirmatory viral test may be a NAAT or an additional antigen test.